

Inequality and Social Mobility - Presentation Teacher Guide

C2 · Ages Adults (20-23) · 90 min · Writing · + Critical Thinking

Presentation - teaching notes

Teacher copy. Keep this guide separate from the student PowerPoint. Slide numbers below refer to the numbered lesson slides; an exported slide may continue over several pages.

1. Inequality and Social Mobility

Evaluate causal claims, distinguish outcomes from mechanisms, and defend a conditional policy judgment.

Task: What do you already know about this topic?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

2. Today's goal

Write a nuanced policy analysis that separates causal hypotheses from evidence, weighs distributional trade-offs and specifies what would justify revision.

Task: Explain the goal in your own words.

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

3. inequality

inequality: An uneven distribution of resources, conditions or outcomes.

Inequality can persist even when a formal rule is equal.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "inequality" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

4. mobility

mobility: Movement between social or economic positions.

A mobility measure needs a defined comparison and period.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "mobility" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

5. systemic

systemic: Arising from the organization of connected institutions or practices.

A systemic barrier may persist without an explicit exclusion rule.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "systemic" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

6. opportunity

opportunity: A meaningful chance to pursue an outcome.

Opportunity depends partly on whether access is usable.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "opportunity" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

7. policy

policy: An organized course of action adopted by an institution.

A policy can have different effects on different groups.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "policy" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

8. Read and notice

Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

Task: Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates?

Teacher note: Use the full reading printed in both worksheet versions. Check the four reading questions against the separate teacher key.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

9. Listen for details

The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

Task: Listen once for the situation, then again for details.

Teacher note: Use the supplied recording or read the exact script in the separate listening teacher copy. Do not display the transcript during the listening check.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

10. Useful language

- The observed association is consistent with ____, but cannot by itself establish ____ .
- The policy's merits depend partly on how ____ is distributed and measured.
- Even if ____, it would not follow that ____; an alternative explanation is ____ .

Task: Adapt one frame to the situation.

Teacher note: These are language models, not answers to the reading or listening questions.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

11. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 1

Council group: Recommend a limited package using the fictional case only. State whose access improves and who may remain excluded.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

12. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 2

Review group: Test the causal assumptions and administrative trade-offs. Do not treat a plausible mechanism as a measured effect.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

13. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 3

Final task: Write a joint recommendation and a short dissent that accurately represents the strongest unresolved objection.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

14. Your final response

State your choice. Give evidence. Recognize a limitation.

Task: What would make you change your response?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.